

APPENDIX 4.1. BIG FIVE INVENTORY RESPONSE FORM AND INSTRUCTIONS TO PARTICIPANTS

Instructions: Here are a number of characteristics that may or may not apply to you. For example, do you agree that you are someone who *likes to spend time with others*? Please write a number next to each statement to indicate the extent to which you agree or disagree with that statement.

1	2	3	4	5
Disagree strongly	Disagree a little	Neither agree nor disagree	Agree a little	Agree strongly

I see myself as someone who ..

1. ☐ Is talkative

2. ☐ Tends to find fault with others

3. ☐ Does a thorough job

4. ☐ Is depressed, blue

5. ☐ Is original, comes up with new ideas

6. ☐ Is reserved

7. ☐ Is helpful and unselfish with others

8. ☐ Can be somewhat careless

9. ☐ Is relaxed, handles stress well

10. ☐ Is curious about many different things

11. ☐ Is full of energy

12. ☐ Starts quarrels with others

13. ☐ Is a reliable worker

14. ☐ Can be tense

15. ☐ Is ingenious, a deep thinker

16. ☐ Generates a lot of enthusiasm

17. ☐ Has a forgiving nature

18. ☐ Tends to be disorganized

19. ☐ Worries a lot

20. ☐ Has an active imagination

21. ☐ Tends to be quiet

22. ☐ Is generally trusting

23. ☐ Tends to be lazy
24. ☐ Is emotionally stable, not easily upset

25. ☐ Is inventive

26. ☐ Has an assertive personality

27. ☐ Can be cold and aloof

28. ☐ Perseveres until the task is finished

29. ☐ Can be moody

30. ☐ Values artistic, aesthetic experiences

31. ☐ Is sometimes shy, inhibited

32. ☐ Is considerate and kind to almost everyone

33. ☐ Does things efficiently

34. ☐ Remains calm in tense situations

35. ☐ Prefers work that is routine

36. ☐ Is outgoing, sociable

37. ☐ Is sometimes rude to others

38. ☐ Makes plans and follows through with them

39. ☐ Gets nervous easily

40. ☐ Likes to reflect, play with ideas

41. ☐ Has few artistic interests

42. ☐ Likes to cooperate with others

43. ☐ Is easily distracted

44. ☐ Is sophisticated in art, music, or literature

Please check: Did you write a number in front of each statement?

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APPENDIX 4.2. SCORING THE BFI SCALES AND ACQUIESCENCE INDEX, AND IPSATIZING THE BFI ITEMS

Computing Simple BFI Scale Scores

BFI scale scoring: Reverse score the items labeled “R” and compute scale scores as the mean of the following items:

Extraversion (8 items): 1, 6R, 11, 16, 21R, 26, 31R, 36
Agreeableness (9 items): 2R, 7, 12R, 17, 22, 27R, 32, 37R, 42
Conscientiousness (9 items): 3, 8R, 13, 18R, 23R, 28, 33, 38, 43R
Neuroticism (8 items): 4, 9R, 14, 19, 24R, 29, 34R, 39
Openness (10 items): 5, 10, 15, 20, 25, 30, 35R, 40, 41R, 44

Computing the Content-Balanced Acquiescence Index and Ipsatizing the BFI Items

To index individuals’ acquiescent response style (where high scores mean “yea-saying” and low scores mean “nay-saying”), we compute their acquiescence score as their mean response across 32 BFI items that form 16 pairs of items with opposite implications for personality (e.g., item 1 “Is talkative” and item 21 “Tends to be quiet”). As described in Soto, John, Gosling, and Potter (2008), we devised these 16 pairs of opposite items on the basis of item content and the size of their (negative) interitem correlations. Using the standard BFI item numbers (see Appendix A; see also Benet-Martínez & John, 1998; John & Srivastava, 1999), these item pairs are 1 and 21, 6 and 16, 31 and 36, 2 and 17, 7 and 12, 27 and 42, 32 and 37, 3 and 43, 8 and 13, 18 and 33, 23 and 28, 9 and 19, 24 and 29, 34 and 39, 5 and 35, 30 and 41.

The Statistical Package for the Social Sciences (SPSS) syntax given below first computes each person’s acquiescence score (“bfave”; the average of his or her $16 \times 2 = 32$ item responses) and response extremeness (“bfstd”; the standard deviation of that person’s 32 item responses). Both of these individual-difference scores may be retained and used in research on individual or group differences in response-scale use (e.g., comparing Asian Americans and European Americans). The syntax below shows how these two scores can be used to ipsatize the full set of 44 BFI items, by removing from each item score the individual’s acquiescence score (i.e., content-balanced response mean) and then adjusting the resulting deviation scores by dividing them by the individual’s standard deviation, resulting in person-centered standard (or Z) scores. The syntax below assumes that the variables for the 44 BFI items are named bfi1 to bfi44 in standard order.

SPSS Syntax to Ipsatize the 44 BFI Items before Scoring the Scales

* Compute within-person response means (bfave) and standard deviations (bfstd).

```
COMPUTE bfave = mean(bfi1, bfi6, bfi16, bfi21, bfi31, bfi36, bfi2, bfi7, bfi12,
bfi17, bfi27, bfi32, bfi37, bfi42, bfi3, bfi8, bfi13, bfi18, bfi23, bfi28, bfi33,
bfi43, bfi9, bfi19, bfi24, bfi29, bfi34, bfi39, bfi5, bfi30, bfi35, bfi41).
```

```
COMPUTE bfstd = sd(bfi1, bfi6, bfi16, bfi21, bfi31, bfi36, bfi2, bfi7, bfi12, bfi17,
bfi27, bfi32, bfi37, bfi42, bfi3, bfi8, bfi13, bfi18, bfi23, bfi28, bfi33, bfi43, bfi9,
bfi19, bfi24, bfi29, bfi34, bfi39, bfi5, bfi30, bfi35, bfi41).
EXECUTE.
```

* Compute ipsatized BFI items (zbfi).

```
COMPUTE zbfi1 = (bfi1 - bfave)/bfstd.
COMPUTE zbfi2 = (bfi2 - bfave)/bfstd.
COMPUTE zbfi3 = (bfi3 - bfave)/bfstd.
.
.
.
COMPUTE zbfi44 = (bfi44 - bfave)/bfstd.
EXECUTE.
```

Then use the ipsatized item scores to compute scale scores as mean item responses, as described above.